Hackfest Hackathon 2026
South & East Regional Round

SAP

September 2026

Student Handbook



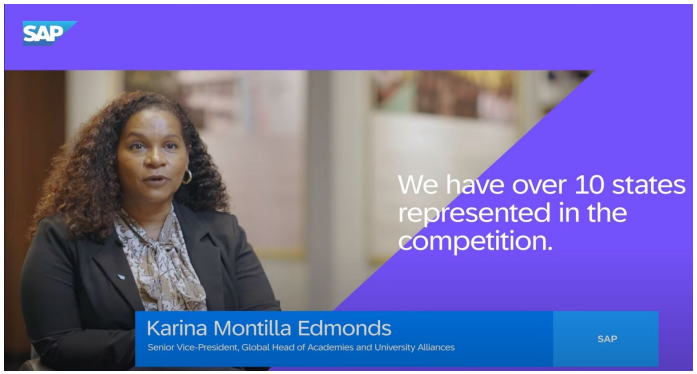
Public

Why Hackfest?

In a world where code is becoming commodity, it is no longer a competitive edge for students. At SAP, we always see problems from Domain, Tech and Business perspectives. Hackfest is an attempt to invigorate the student community, with these principles to solve real world burning problems, using this framework.



Hackfest 2023



Hackfest 2024

Public

Hackfest Journey So Far

2022

- 120 Teams
- 600 students
- 1 state
- 0 SAP Partners/Customers
- Prizes worth 2500 USD

2023

- 500 Teams
- 2500 students
- 4 states
- 2 SAP Customers
- ~100 Volunteers
- 6 Regional Rounds
- Prizes worth 3500 USD

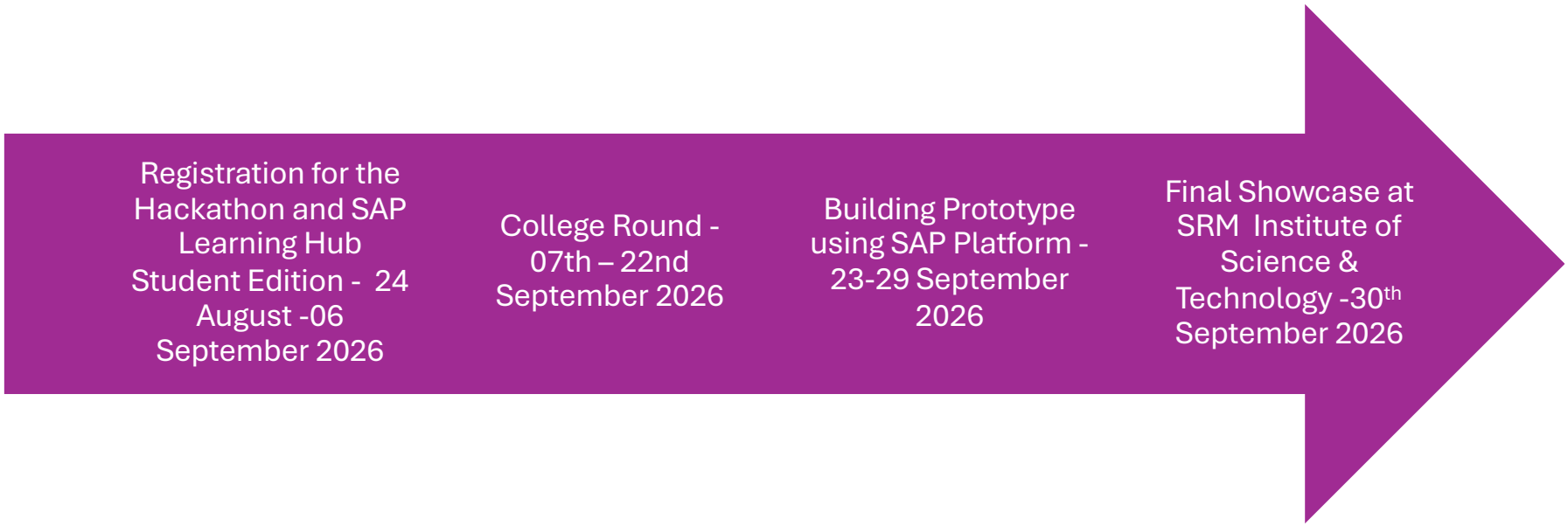
2024

- 2500 Teams
- 12500 students
- 10 states
- 10 SAP Customers/Partners
- 25 Regional Rounds
- ~600 Volunteers
- Prizes worth 6000 USD

2025

- 4000 Teams
- 20 - 25k students
- 15 states
- 20 state hubs
- 200 regional rounds
- Prize Pool of 12000 USD

Timelines



Public

When the world fractures, supply chains must think for themselves.

Theme 1: Resilient Supply Chains

- When global supply chains break, the human cost is massive. Delays disrupt life-saving medicine, raise food prices for vulnerable populations, and wipe out incomes for small-scale farmers.
- This supply chain has now shifted from cost-optimized to resilience-first. Driven by maritime re-routings, dynamic tariff policies, geopolitical shifts, and climate shocks, structural disruption is now a constant reality. Traditional planning tools can no longer keep pace.
- Supply chain resilience is a top priority for SAP's global customers. Using industry foundations like SAP IBP, Transportation Management, and Ariba, along with next-gen SAP Joule AI Agents, businesses are shifting toward autonomous, self-healing networks. This Hackfest gives you direct experience in the exact space where enterprise tech is evolving fastest.
- **This year's SAP Hackfest challenges you to harness Agentic AI to build supply chains that don't just react, but autonomously sense, adapt, and recover in real time.**
- Your solution will leverage a team of specialized AI agents:

- Sensing & Scenario Agents
- Logistics & Inventory Agents
- Compliance & Human-in-the-Loop Safeguards

Public

AI is rewriting who gets to work. The question is whether it rewrites the rules fairly.

Theme 2: Inclusive Workforce

- AI is reshaping global employment, turning traditional hiring upside down and creating a $5.5T global skills gap. The challenge is no longer *"Will AI take jobs?"* It's *"Who will AI leave behind?"*
- Human Capital Management is at the core of SAP's strategic focus. Through SAP SuccessFactors, the Talent Intelligence Hub, and next-gen Joule AI Agents, SAP is leading the shift toward skills-first hiring, automated talent development, and smart recruiting. This theme isn't abstract. It's about your future workforce.
- **Your challenge is to build AI solutions that include, empower, and upskill. Hackfest teams will design a multi-agent AI ecosystem where below-mentioned specialized agents collaborate to create a fair, skill-first workforce platform:**

- Skills Discovery Agent
- Market Intelligence Agent
- Learning Pathway Agent
- Inclusive Matching Agent
- Employer Readiness & Bias Audit Agents
- Human-in-the-Loop

Public

From Idea to Prototype: The Two-Round Process

Theme 1: Resilient Supply Chains

Round 1 (Regional College Round): Design Thinking & Business Model *(No Code)*

The Challenge: Select a supply chain scenario (e.g., pharma cold chain, disaster relief logistics, or tariff-exposed networks).

The Deliverable: Perform empathy mapping, identify system failure modes, map agent-human interactions, and build a Business Model Canvas using the SAP Learning Hub, student edition

Round 2 (Grand Finale): Prototyping & Live Demo

Single Agent Prototype: Build a functional core agent (e.g., a *Disruption Sensing* or *Scenario Planning Agent*) using vibe coding and AI frameworks.

Full System Showcase: Demo an end-to-end multi-agent network simulating a live disruption (e.g., shipping closures or tariff spikes)—showing autonomous rerouting, audit logging, human approval, and SAP Learning Hub, student edition integration.

Theme 2: Inclusive Workforce

Round 1 (Regional College Round): Design Thinking & Business Model *(No Code)*

The Challenge: Select an inclusion challenge (e.g., reskilling displaced workers, matching persons with disabilities, or supporting women re-entering the workforce).

The Deliverable: Conduct empathy mapping, identify systemic hiring barriers, design agent-human interaction models, and build a sustainable Business Model Canvas using the SAP Learning Hub, student edition.

Round 2 (Grand Finale): Prototyping & Live Demo

Single Agent Prototype: Build a functional core agent (e.g., a *Skills Discovery* or *Learning Pathway Agent*) using vibe coding and AI frameworks.

Full System Showcase: Demo the complete multi-agent "Career Orchestrator" end-to-end via a real-world persona (e.g., a woman re-entering the workforce in a tier-2 city), demonstrating seamless agent collaboration, human-in-the-loop safeguards, and SAP Learning Hub, student edition integration.

Public

Evaluation Criteria

Teams working on any chosen theme will identify the following:

- Persona
- User Needs
- Problem Statement
- Solution

Public

Evaluation Criteria

Persona Development

Evaluates how well teams understand their users through realistic, detailed persona creation. Good personas include demographics, behaviors, goals, and pain points.

- 0: Personas lack detail or realism
- 1: Personas have some depth but missing key elements
- 2: Well-developed personas with clear demographics, goals, pain points

Problem Statement Clarity

Rates how precisely teams define the problem they're solving. Clear problem statements identify specific issues, affected populations, and contextual factors.

- 0: Problem is vague or poorly defined
- 1: Problem is identified but lacks specificity or scope
- 2: Problem is clearly articulated with specific context and impact

Public

Evaluation Criteria

User Needs Identification

Assesses teams' understanding of underlying user needs. Higher scores for comprehensive needs analysis backed by research or evidence.

- 0: User needs not identified or misaligned with personas
- 1: Basic needs identified but lacking depth or insight
- 2: Comprehensive understanding of user needs with supporting evidence

Solution Alignment

Measures how directly the proposed solution addresses identified problems and needs. Strong alignment shows clear connections between solution features and user requirements.

- 0: Solution doesn't address the defined problem
- 1: Solution partially addresses the problem
- 2: Solution directly addresses the problem with clear connection to user needs

Public

Learning Assets

Hands-On Practice Systems

SAP BTP – Hands-on Practice for Develop extensions with CAP following the SAP BTP Developer's Guide
SAP Build - SAP Build , SAP Business Application Studio – Sandbox , Advanced SAP UI5 Development
SAP S/4HANA -SPS07 - SAP HANA Installing and Administering , Provisioning data to SAP HANA Cloud , SAP HANA Cloud - Modeling
SAP SAC - Exploring SAP Analytics Cloud , SAP Analytics Cloud: Modeling and Data Transformation , SAP Analytics Cloud: Story Design
SAP BDC – Applying AI-powered Visualizations and Augmented Analytics to Business Data in SAP Analytics Cloud
SAP GEN AI- Solve your business problems using prompts and LLMs in SAP Generative AI Hub

Trial Systems

SAP S/4HANA- Get Started with the SAP HANA Database Explorer | SAP Tutorials , Get Started with SAP HANA Cloud | SAP Tutorials
SAP BTP & Build - Create Your First App on Cloud Foundry | SAP Tutorials , Get Started with SAP Business Technology Platform SAP HANA Service | SAP Tutorials , Create an Application with SAP Build Apps | SAP Tutorials
SAP BDC - SAP Business Data Cloud trial

Public

Need to Know

- Registration on the SAP Learning Hub, student edition is **mandatory** for participation in the SAP Hackfest.
- Each team can consist of **4 (min) - 5 (max) participants**. Not more or less than that.
- During Regional Round, **only ideas** will be evaluated based on the learnings from SAP Learning Hub, student edition courses, it is **not mandatory** to have a working prototype.
- For the Regional College Round, hardware only ideas/prototypes to be **disqualified**. However, **combination** of Hardware and Software or Pure Software based ideas **are allowed**.
- Each team will be given **15 mins in total**; 10 mins of time to pitch and 5 mins for Q&A.
- **Top 5** teams from each Regional College Round will progress to the Final Round.
- In the finale, teams must design, develop and **demonstrate a functional prototype leveraging SAP technologies**.

Public



Thank You

Public